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DEXTER AVENUE BAPTIST CHURCH

You the people of Dexter Avenue Baptist Church have called me to serve as pastor of your historic church; and I have gladly accepted the call. It is with more than perfunctory gratitude that I offer my appreciation to you for bestowing upon me this great honor. I accept the pastorate dreadfully aware of the tremendous responsibilities accompanying it. Contrary to some shallow thinking, the responsibilities of the pastorate both stagger and astound the imagination. They tax the whole man.

JANUARY 24, 1954
King delivers trial sermon at Dexter Avenue Baptist Church in Montgomery, Alabama

FEBRUARY 28
Delivers guest sermon at Second Baptist Church in Detroit, Michigan

APRIL 14
Accepts call to Dexter's pastorate

MAY 2
Delivers first sermon as Dexter's minister

OCTOBER 31
Offically becomes pastor of Dexter; King Sr. delivers installation sermon

AUGUST 26, 1955
Rosa Parks, secretary of Montgomery NAACP chapter, informs King of his election to executive committee

NOVEMBER 17
First child, Yolanda Denise, is born

After being in school twenty-one years without a break, I reached the satisfying moment of completing the residential requirements for the Ph.D. degree. The major job that remained was to write my doctoral thesis. In the